Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠K

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣J

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ J 10 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ A 8 5



♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

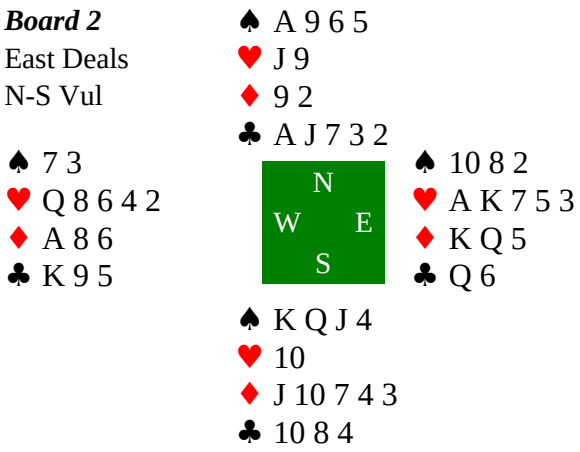
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠K

After EAST opens with 1♥, WEST has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K 10 6 2

♠ 9 4
♥ K Q 10 6 3
♦ 10 4 2
♣ A 7 4



♠ A 6 2
♥ 9 8 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 10 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1♦.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 8 2 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ J 10 2	
♠ K Q J 7 4 ♥ K Q 2 ♦ A J 6 ♣ 9 3		♠ 10 9 6 3 ♥ 7 5 4 ♦ Q 7 ♣ A K 6 4
	♠ A 5 ♥ A J 9 8 ♦ K 8 5 ♣ Q 8 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♣J

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

WEST has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. EAST isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. WEST has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. EAST has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.